



Netflix Streamfest

You can check out Netflix movies and shows for free on 5 and 6 December, as part of Netflix Streamfest. <https://digit.in/dec20-71>



Facebook Vanish Mode

FB adds a "Vanish Mode" for messages in Messenger and Instagram, that deletes itself, once read. <https://digit.in/dec20-72>

the motherboard which only leaves out the RAM module itself.

We then pulled the module out and started examining it up close. Disassembling the module was quite easy and all we had to do was remove four screws and pull the heat spreaders apart. The LED strip was at the absolute top and connected to the RAM module using a simple ribbon cable. We detached the LED strip and swapped it out with the healthy RAM module from the kit. We then plugged both modules back onto the motherboard and gave it a

go. The faulty LED was now on the other module. So we had now isolated the fault with the LED strip and the RAM module itself was healthy.

Upon closely examining the LED strip we finally found the fault. RGB LEDs use three resistors for the R, G and B elements. These are usually of the same value. We saw that one of the LEDs was actually placed awkwardly on the strip and the contact had actually been short circuited. So only two of the RGB elements had any resistors while the third one was directly connected to the signal line.

This is problematic in the long run since LEDs aren't meant to be run without a resistor and will burn out over time. While we could fix this with a bit of soldering, it was much better to send the unit for RMA while hoping that they wouldn't figure out that we'd already disassembled the unit. A few weeks down the line, we had the replacement and everything was back to normal. While the entire process was quite arduous but it was quite fun. I almost ended-up questioning the hate that RGB receives... almost. 

BUYING ADVICE

MISSING DRIVER SOFTWARE

Q Dear Agent001, I'm encountering a problem regarding Realtek HD Audio Manager that won't open after the Windows 10 (64 bit) 1903 update. I tried to download a fresh audio



Realtek Driver Manager

driver (V 2.82) for Realtek ALC 887 from the Realtek website but it didn't solve the problem. I even visited the GIGABYTE's website for the updated drivers for GA-B85M-D3H (rev. 2.0) but latest updated drivers they have are as of 23/02/2016 (v 7727). Please help as I am unable to configure my 5.1 speaker system without the Realtek audio manager. Also suggest some free driver installer/updater.

Thanks.

Tarun Avtar

A Hey Tarun, The motherboard you've mentioned, i.e. the GA-B85M-D3H (rev. 2.0) uses the newer ALC 892 CODEC and not the ALC 887. The driver packages are the same and the latest package is what gets messed up with the latest driver update. You can use the older package i.e. R2.81 from file archive websites such as FileHippo and install the same. People have found the Audio manager working just fine after downgrading to the previous driver package. So getting the older drivers on GIGABYTE's website should solve your problem provided they're compatible with your current Windows build. If not, hunt down R2.81 from FileHippo and install the same.

TABLET FOR VIDEO CALLS

Q Hi Agent001, My daughter's school has started up and like all schools, most of her lectures happen online. She's been using my laptop for the last couple of months but I have to head out to another city for a few days and I'll be taking my laptop with me. So I need a budget laptop for her so that her classes can continue as usual. This is only for a few days so I don't wish to spend a lot on an iPad or something similarly expensive. Also,

I don't want something so cheap that video calls are barely possible. Please let me know my options.

-Satish K.

A Hey Satish, You can find the 8-inch HONOR Pad 5 meeting your needs. Since you haven't specified a budget, I've gone with a tablet around the INR 15K price point since that's about the sweet spot because at 20K you'll start getting low-end laptops which will struggle with more than one application running at any time. And at around 10K, you'll get cheap tablets which also underperform severely. The Honor Pad 5 is powered by a Kirin 710 and you

should ideally get the 4GB RAM model rather than the 3GB RAM model. It even has 4G LTE support so you can install a SIM card and continue your work without Wi-Fi. Most of the common video calling apps such as Meet and Zoom will work flawlessly on the tablet. Hope it works well for your daughter's classes. If any of her software requires a PC, then you'll have to explore

a laptop in the INR 25-30K range. There's an Intel-powered Dell Inspiron 3583 at 27K and an AMD-powered HP 15 db1069AU at 30K which should meet your daughter's needs. 



HONOR Pad 5